मन्त्रपुष्पम् (Mantrapushpam)

Abstract
This research work systematically interprets selected Vēdic concepts to demonstrate the interrelation of sound, knowledge, and being. The Vēda employs the consonantal groups क, च, ट, त, प and their nasals to encode epistemic processes, framing ideation as *yajña*, the creative act governed by *Prajāpati* and directed toward divine awareness (*kalpa*). Desire (*paśu*) underlies all action, which attains sacred status when infused with divine consciousness. *Brahman* manifests as *Śabda-Brahman*, the totality of sound and knowledge. The *RigVēda* and *Yajur Vēda* reveal the causal link between divine energy and ritual activity. The *Puṣpa* symbolizes the creative expansion of *Āpaśakti*, while *ta-kāra* signifies *pratiṣṭhā*, the principle grounding consciousness in the inner locus of realization (*āyatana*).

Introduction
The arising of "ऊह " (*ūha)* (imaginative conception or intuitive thought) is the primordial *yajna*, the first act of creation. Only after the emergence of *ūha* do all other actions proceed. *Yajña* signifies the unification of the mind with knowledge in order to accomplish what is desired. In this process, three elements converge: effort (*prayatna*), mind (*manas*), and knowledge (*jñāna*).
The performer of the *yajña* is *Prajāpati*, as stated in the *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.8.23): "*Yajñaḥ Prajāpatiḥ*," and again in (3.7.1): "*Prajāpatyo Yajñaḥ*." In the Vēdic context, *prajā* refers to *ūhas*, the conceptual offspring or mental projections. The birthplace of these *ūhas* is the union of mind and knowledge. The power that generates them, or the one who gives them birth, is *Prajāpati*.
The Vēda designates the locus of this generative process as the *samudra* (cosmic ocean). *Prajāpati* not only brings forth *ūhas* but also transforms them into integral parts of living existence, nurturing and developing them as inherent tendencies of beings. Hence, the *Brāhmaṇa* declares: "*Prajāpatyo Yajñaḥ*", the *yajña* itself is *Prajāpati*. The *ūhas* thus produced are infinite and innumerable.
What becomes of the thoughts (*ūhas*) that arise continually? They must ultimately merge into their source, the primordial knowledge (*mūla-jñāna*). In other words, they inevitably return to their origin. It is the very nature of creation that all that is born must return to its source. This process occurs perpetually within both the microcosm (*sūkṣma-aṇḍa*) and the macrocosm (*brahmāṇḍa*). This too is a form of *yajña*.
In the *Taittirīya Saṃhitā*, particularly within the *Vājapeya* section, the principal Vēdic words are *yajña* and *kalpa*. Yet, without understanding the meaning of these key words, the essence of the mantra cannot be grasped. The sense of Vēdic words must be realized through their phonetic and symbolic value through the vision of the Vēdākshara themselves.
The Vēdākshara "क" (*ka)* is the first *sparśākṣara* (consonant of contact); therefore, it denotes action (*kriyā*). Hence, the expression "*kaḥ Prajāpatiḥ*", "Who is Prajāpati?"- indicates that *Prajāpati* manifests through action (*prajā* as creative activity). The Vēdākshara "र" (*ra)* signifies the living being (*jīva*).
In the word *kalpamu* (*ka + la + pa + ma + u*):

- क represents action (*kriyā-sambandha*),
- ल signifies the *jīva* in its divine state,
- प relates to the three bodies (*sthūla*, *sūkṣma*, and *kāraṇa*),
- म pertains to the mind, and
- उ denotes consecration or priestly invocation (*purohitam*).

Kalpa signifies the process of directing the three bodies - physical, subtle, and causal, toward the realization of the Brahman-consciousness through the mind. In essence, it is the *yajña* performed by the *jīva* with the desire to attain the divine state (*dēva-bhāva*).
In the Vēda, words associated with knowledge are expressed through the phonetic classes क च ट त प, each group employing its respective "पञ्चम वर्ण " (*pañcama varṇa* -nasal consonant). The thoughts (*ūhas*) that arise within us are based upon the innate knowledge that accompanies birth. The arising of thought itself is *yajña*; the power that generates thought is *Prajāpati*; and the movement of consciousness toward the divine state is *Kalpa*.
Another significant Vēdic term is *paśu*. What becomes of the thoughts born within living beings? Not all return to their source. Through the operation of mind and knowledge, we transform them into desires

(*kāmāḥ*). The Vēda designates this desire as *paśu*. The living being's natural tendency is to perform *yajña* continually for the attainment of this *paśu*.
In this process, one employs the vital and mental faculties - *āyus*, *prāṇa*, *apāna*, *vyāna*, *cakṣus* (vision), *śrotra* (hearing), *manas* (mind), *vāk* (speech), and *ātman*. When these energies are directed toward worldly outcomes and temporal gains, the act remains mere *karma*; but when they are united with divine consciousness (*dēva-bhāva*), that same act becomes *yajña*.
The word *paśu* itself is composed of the Vēdāksharas "प, श, उ " (*pa*, *śa*, and *u)* each bearing symbolic meaning:

- प corresponds to the three bodies.
- श denotes peace, comfort, and auspiciousness.
- उ represents the vital principle (*prāṇa-akṣara*).

Thus, *paśu* signifies the *desire* that bestows peace and harmony upon the three bodies - the physical, the mental, and the intellectual. Desires that lead toward the divine state (*dēvatā-sthiti*) are those which yield true bliss (*ānanda*). When our daily actions, ordinarily the *paśus* of our existence are suffused with divine consciousness (*dēva-bhāva*), they elevate the being toward higher states of realization.
A *yajña* performed with divine awareness is capable of attaining the *paśu*, for the *paśu* is inherently related to *yajña*. To attain the *paśu* is to attain the *brahma-bhāva*, the state of unity with Brahman. These *paśus* are therefore *yajña*-related entities (*yajña-sambandhinaḥ*). The field to which the realized *paśus* return is *saṃjñāna* (perfect cognition or awakened consciousness).
The place of the birth of *ūha* (creative thought or intuition) is also *saṃjñāna*. When countless *paśus* (refined desires or realized energies) converge into *saṃjñāna*, it becomes strengthened and luminous. The thoughts (*ūhas*) arising from such a field are purer and more potent than before. This *kalpa*, the process by which mind, body, and knowledge are directed toward divine realization is itself the embodiment of creative power.
As stated in the *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.9.6):
"Prajā vai paśavo garbhaḥ; prajāmeva paśūn ātmānaṃ dhatte."
"Indeed, the progenies (*prajāḥ*) are the *paśus*; and the Self (Ātman) takes the *paśus*, the progenies into itself as its own."
In the Vēdic idiom, *garbha* (womb) signifies the path through which the *jīva* attains luminosity and realization. The *paśus*, that is, the vital desires or energies are to be directed upon the *Brahma-mārga* (the path of divine consciousness) for the sake of the "noble progeny," the enlightened forms of creation. Hence, as affirmed in *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (2.2.8):
"Yajamānaḥ paśuḥ."
"The yajñar himself is the *paśu*."
The *yajamāna* is the one who assumes the *state of yajna*, that is, the conscious condition during the performance of a *yajña*. In that moment, both the mind and the beings (*jīvas*) become *paśu-maya* imbued with divine aspirations and transformed desires. The *yajamāna* thus becomes the *paśu* himself, for he embodies the very form of the desire permeated by the *brahma-bhāva* (the realization of Brahman).
Through the discipline of *nitya-yajña* (the perpetual yajña), one gradually attains higher states of being. The *ūhas* (intuitive perceptions) are the natural expressions of living beings; yet, for the transformation of their innate tendencies (*janma-lakṣaṇa*), the performance of *Vēda-mantra*-based *yajña* is essential.
As the fruit of such *yajña*, *āyuḥ* (life), *prāṇa* (vital force), and their refinements reach their highest condition through *kalpa*. The divine consciousness within *yajña* is realized through the *agni-kārya* (ritual function of Agni) and the recitation of Vēdic mantras. This ritual and functional process of Agni is itself called *kalpa*. Hence, *kalpa* is a *vāk-yajña*, a yajña performed through sacred speech.
Here, *vāk* refers to *mantra-infused utterance* formed by the Vēdāksharas (*akṣaras*) of the Vēda. The *vāk-yajña* is profoundly esoteric and rich with layers of meaning. Through *svādhyāya* (self-recitation) and *pravacana* (teaching), it grants to beings the energy required to manifest their *ūhas* (intuitions), *bhāvas* (sentiments), and *jñāna* (knowledge). By organizing the right combinations of Vēdāksharas, each vibrating with subtle potency, the *vāk-yajña* bestows upon living beings the power to realize their *paśus*, that is, their refined and divinized desires.
Just as, at the dawn of creation, *ākāśa* (space) appeared as the first manifestation, *vāyu* (air) expanded through it, and *pṛthvī* (earth) spread forth below, in the same manner *śabda-brahman,* the Vēda itself

unfolded through vibration and resonance. The *vākas* (words) within *kalpa* reveal the process by which divine consciousness (*dēvatā-bhāva*) arises through *vāk-yajña*.
Thus, the expression *"Yajñena kalpatām"* conveys the essence that one must *become perfected through yajña*.
The *vāk-yajña* empowers *āyuḥ*, *prāṇa*, *apāna*, *vyāna*, *cakṣuḥ*, *śrotra*, and the other *indriyas* (senses). The process of *kalpa* strengthens and refines them.
The word *indriya* itself composed of the Vēdāksharas न, द, र, य (*na*, *da*, *ra*, *ya)* implies the instruments through which, by means of *yajña*, divine consciousness is attained and directed toward the seat of knowledge (*jñāna-sthāna*). Hence, each mantra joins the word *indriya* to signify: "Through this *yajña*, may we attain divine realization."
The Vēdic declaration, *"Ātmā yajñena kalpatām"* ("May the Self be perfected through yajña"), explicitly identifies the *Ātman* as itself an *indriya*, an organ of divine perception.
In Vēdic language, such words possess meanings that differ profoundly from their conventional Sanskrit equivalents. Whereas Sanskrit fixes a lexical sense, Vēdic speech unveils a cosmological and metaphysical dimension where every *akṣara* (Vēdākshara) embodies a force of creation and transformation.
When the Vēdic expression **"Yajño yajñena kalpatām"** is uttered, it signifies that through the *Vāk-yajña* (yajña by speech), all subsequent yajñas occurring within living beings, the vital operations such as *āyuḥ*, *prāṇa*, *apāna*, and others are elevated into the state of *Brahma-bhāva* (divine consciousness). Through the recitation and hearing of Vēdic mantras, the inner senses (*indriyas*) of all beings are energized and attain an exalted condition.
To perceive and experience the *three bodies* - the physical, vital, and cognitive as one integrated unity, and to direct them toward *Brahma-consciousness*, is declared by the Vēda as the **"Dēva-bhāvanābhimukha-sthiti"**, the state oriented toward divine realization. In this state arise *ūhas* (intuitive imaginations, here termed *prajās*) and *kāmanās* (desires, here termed *paśus*). These become fit, through *kalpa*, to apprehend the inner mysteries of creation.
To unite the literal meaning (*akṣara-ārtha*) with realization is itself *tapas* (spiritual austerity), and this union is called *kalpa*.
Brahman is **complete knowledge** (*sampūrṇa-jñāna*). That perfect knowledge manifests as *akṣara-śakti*, the power of Vēdāksharas. These divine powers (*dēvatā-śaktis*) become embodied as **sākāra-akṣaras**, the visible and audible Vēdāksharas. The collective of such Vēdāksharas constitutes the **form of Parabrahman**, for *śabda-brahman* means "Brahman manifested as sound." Therefore, *śabda-brahman* is of the very nature of complete, self-luminous knowledge.
The divine powers that emanate from Brahman diversify into innumerable functional forms of creative activity. Thus, every action performed by human beings is ultimately an outcome of those divine potencies. The same applies to the realm of Vēdāksharas: *śabda-brahman* becomes *akṣara-śakti*, the energetic power of Vēdāksharas and these powers, taking concrete form as *akṣaras* (Vēdāksharas), combine in manifold ways to generate **Sarasvata expression**, the creative flow of language and meaning. This is the very mode by which the *śabda-brahman* constitutes the *Vēdic universe*.
Since the *akṣaras* are fragments (*khaṇḍas*) of Brahma-jñāna, the Vēda composed of these Vēdāksharas is truly the **edifice of Brahma-knowledge** (*Brahma-jñāna-saudha*). All of creation is thus a reflection of the *akṣaras*, for each Vēdākshara is a portion of divine knowledge, a symbol of the gods. Hence, all living beings, being composed of such syllabic energy, are fundamentally *śāktika* endowed with divine power.
The *akṣara* perceivable by the organ of hearing (*śravaṇendriya-gocara*) is employed in this world to construct languages. Yet, the **Dēvatā-śakti** that resides within the Vēdākshara transcends the limits of human cognition. What is heard is the *sound* (*śabda*) of the *akṣara*, but the divine potency within it remains imperceptible, dwelling in the **Param-vyoma** - the supreme ether of consciousness.
Though those divine forces remain beyond ordinary perception, through *Vāk-yajña* they awaken within the being as **Dēvatā-bhāva**, the divine disposition. The processes by which these divine energies take concrete form, become manifest as knowledge, and reenter the field of human awareness, are mysteries that lie beyond ordinary imagination (*ūhā*).
In essence, the descent of divine energy into *sākāra* (manifest form), its transformation into knowledge, and its awakening within human consciousness constitute the sacred cycle of *Vāk-yajña*. Though the

subtle activities of these divine forces are imperceptible, their reflection is realized within the aspirant as illumination, inspiration, and the stirring of divine intuition.
The truth that we comprehend is this: the function of air is the sustenance of life, which occurs through the process of inhalation and exhalation; and the function of water is the preservation of life, which is experienced through the quenching of thirst. Thus, air serves the nourishment of life, and water ensures its protection. These principles correspond to the functions of the *Vēdic Vēdāksharas*, namely, the generation of divine cognition (*dēva-bhāva sṛjanā*), the realization of one's true nature (*sva-svarūpa-jñāna-bodhana*), and the process of study and recitation (*adhyayana–pravacana*). Through these three, the deeper purpose of the *Vēdic word* becomes known.
In every *Vēdic* teaching, the process by which all phenomena emerge, differentiate, and manifest from *Brahman*, the primordial source of creation, is explained. Therefore, whenever doubt arises, one must seek its clarification within the *Vēda* itself. The *Vēda* does not separate *Brahman* from the world; rather, it reveals the continuous order through which the universe arises from the Absolute. Whether it is a *Vēda*, an *Anuvāka*, or a *Mantra*, each possesses an essential causal principle that must be understood.
Just as a tree unfolds from its seed and expands to fill space, the *akṣara-dēva-śakti*, the divine energy latent within the human being emerges as the *Vēdākshara (akṣara)*, and then as *speech (vāk)*. This expressed speech becomes the foundation for the great edifice of *Sārasvata*, the structure of knowledge and expression. Because the *Vēda* itself has arisen from the eternal source, every phenomenon contains both a cause and an effect that can be discerned through it.
The *RigVēda* commences with *Agni*, the divine energy that is the root of all *dēva-śakti* (divine powers). The *Yajur Vēda*, in turn, begins with *Īṣā* and *Ūrjas*, the two principles that are the sources of all *karmic* and *sacrificial* activity (*yajña*). These two words - *Īṣā* and *Ūrjas* serve as gateways to a sublime cosmic reality, through which many of the hidden mysteries of the *Vēda* are revealed.
This *Anuvāka* begins with the Vēdāksharas *ya* - signifying *effort (yatna)* and *apām*, denoting the *āpaḥ-śakti*, the power inherent in the waters. This mantra, a flower of the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda*, symbolizes the creative potency through which, by the agency of *Brahman*, the *divine powers (dēva-śakti)* and human beings together participate in the process of creation. In this way, the *āpaḥ-śakti*, assisted by the *Vēdic Word (Vēda-vāk)*, generates and sustains the flowering of existence itself.
The central concept here is the *flower (puṣpa)*, which symbolizes *progeny (prajā)*. Throughout the *Vēda* across various contexts, hymns, chapters, and *anuvāka-s*, the terms *prajā* (offspring) and *paśu* (living beings or vital desires) recur frequently. The underlying reason for this recurrence lies in the concept of the *flower*, for the *flower* itself embodies both *prajā* and *paśu*. The *Chandra (Moon)*, representing a divine power, is invoked as the source of the *waters (āpah)*, from which *prajā* and *paśu* arise. This mantra elucidates how the *āpaḥ-śakti*, the creative, life-sustaining energy, manifests itself in multiple forms throughout creation.
If the verse were merely a human composition, it would have described a process beginning from *paśu* and *prajā* leading up to *āpaḥ-śakti*. However, the Vēdic standpoint is the reverse: here, *Chandra*, as the Vēdic Word (*Vēda-vāk*), is portrayed as the divine force that generates *prajā* and *paśu*, whose ultimate cause is the *āpaḥ-śakti*. The *āpaḥ-śakti* gives rise to *paśu* (desires) and *prajā* (thoughts or imaginative impulses). Through the support of the *Vēdic Word*, this energy manifests the *flower (puṣpa)*, the symbol of creative unfoldment.
From the second to the eighth mantra of the section, the same question is addressed repeatedly: for any thought or imagination (*bhāva* or *ūha*) to arise, a substratum (*āyatana*) is required. Thus, each mantra begins with the expression "*yo 'pām āyatanaṃ Vēda, āyatanavān bhavati*", "He who knows the substratum of the waters becomes possessed of a substratum." This *āyatana* itself arises from the *āpaḥ-śakti*, for without the *Vēdic Word*, the floral (*puṣpa-yuta*) substratum cannot manifest.
The term *āyatana* consists of the phonemes *a, ya, ta, na,* and *ma*, each carrying symbolic import. It signifies "the locus wherein the living being, through knowledge (*jñāna*), mind (*manas*), effort (*yatna*), and inner potency (*mūla-śakti*), establishes his own field of creation." In this sense, every human act leaves its imprint within the *ta-kāra*, the Vēdākshara symbolizing *pratiṣṭhā* (foundation or establishment). The *Vēda* continually employs the *ta-kāra* to indicate this act of establishing; for in every endeavor, the living being situates his awareness within this principle of foundation.
When the mind perceives an object and declares, "I know this," it brings the corresponding *āyatana* before its awareness. All experiences of beings accumulate within the *ta-kāra* as *āyatanas*. Each mental

image or impression (*ūha*) is influenced by these inner *āyatanas*. The *āyatana* is a most wondrous reality it encompasses symbols, signs, and cognitive imprints. The entire cultivation of life consists of forming such subtle impressions and establishing them within the *ta-kāra*, hence the name *āyatana*.
Even experiences of long-ago scenes witnessed, or emotions felt can reappear vividly in consciousness, producing the same sensations as before. The *āyatana-śakti*, therefore, is the very principle of life: to live is to receive and hold *āyatanas*. The exact nature or form of *āyatana* is unknowable, yet every *yajña* (sacrificial act) gives rise to one. Each breath every inhalation and exhalation is itself a *yajña*, and every such *yajña* establishes its own *āyatana*. These may be actions consciously performed, spontaneously occurring, or mysteriously caused yet all leave enduring imprints on the mind.
The Vēdic recitation (*mantra-ucchāraṇa yajña*) is thus intimately connected to both mind and vital energy (*manas* and *prāṇa*). The *Vēdic Vēdākshara (akṣara)*, emerging through *svara* (intonation), *mātrā* (measure), *bāla* (strength), *laya* (rhythm), and *chandas* (meter), manifests as a living entity intended to be united with mind and breath. The *āyatana-s* formed through study (*adhyayana*), recitation (*pravacana*), and ritual (*yajña*) never abandon the living being, they dwell within the *ta-kāra* and gradually awaken divine awareness (*dēva-bhāva*) in the field of imagination.
The Vēdic scholar *Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara* describes this as *śruti-sāmarthya*, the inherent potency of the *Vēda* to generate living consciousness. *Śruti* signifies both revelation and the capacity to adhere to life. The power that brings forth *āyatanas* within the living being is itself *Brahman* assuming divine form (*dēva-rūpa*). Hence, *āyatana* is the dynamic energy capable of producing *puṣpa*, *prajā*, and *paśu*, that is, the full range of life and creativity.
Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara interprets the word *āyatana* in two principal ways: first, as *sthāna*, the locus wherein creation unfolds through knowledge, mind, effort, and innate power; and second, as *kāraṇa*, the causal principle that enables recollection and recognition. Thus, both *locus* and *cause* are appropriate interpretations in the exegetical context.
Finally, the *āyatana* is not an external phenomenon but an interior one, an element of the inner life of the being. Its location cannot be specified; only awareness of its existence is experienced. This awareness is called *abhighnata* (cognitive recognition). Every form of knowing, whether sensory perception, imagination, or intuitive awareness requires a certain force or power of recognition. It is through this power that diverse sages and thinkers in their respective fields have revealed the workings of consciousness to humankind. *Abhighnata* itself transcends the senses; though some impressions arise from perception or imagination, many originate beyond the reach of the senses, leaving subtle marks upon consciousness. These marks, whether mental, symbolic, or intuitive, constitute the very essence of lived experience.

Discussion

In this section we will take some important statements from the introduction section and give method numbers and reference numbers to show evidence to those selected statements.
The Vēda employs the consonants क, च, ट, त, प, and the respective nasalized fifth Vēdāksharas of each group, to express terms related to knowledge. The ideas or imaginations that arise within us are based upon the innate knowledge with which we are born. The act of ideation itself constitutes *Yajña* (sacrificial activity); the generative power responsible for it is *Prajāpati* (the Lord of creation); and the movement toward the divine state of awareness is termed Kalpa [Method-1, Ref (1)].
The Vēda designates desire itself with the term *Paśu* (creature or object of pursuit). The natural characteristic of living beings is the continual performance of *Yajña*, the sacrificial act in the pursuit of this *Paśu*. In this process of attainment, the vital and cognitive faculties - *Āyuḥ* (lifespan), *Prāṇa* (vital breath), *Apāna*, *Vyāna*, *Cakṣus* (sight), *Śrotra* (hearing), *Manas* (mind), *Vāk* (speech), and *Ātman* (self) are all employed. When this dynamic energy is directed toward ordinary, worldly achievements, it remains mere *karma* (action). However, when the same activity is imbued with divine consciousness, it transforms into *Yajña* (a sacred act of offering) [Method-2, Ref (2)].
Brahman is complete and perfect knowledge. That complete knowledge itself manifests as the *akṣara-śaktis*, the imperishable powers of sound. These divine energies take form as *sākāra akṣaras*, or manifest phonetic entities. The collection of such *akṣaras* constitutes the very form of *Parabrahman*. The

term *Śabda-Brahman* denotes Brahman transformed into sound; hence, *Śabda-Brahman* is the embodiment of complete and absolute knowledge [Method-3, Ref (3)].
Since the Vēda itself has manifested into existence, every aspect within it contains both a cause and its corresponding effect. The *RigVēda* commences with *Agni*, the primal energy that serves as the fundamental source of all divine powers. The *YajurVēda*, on the other hand, begins with *Iṣā* and *Ūrjas*, the two foundational principles that constitute the causal forces behind all *karmas* or sacrificial actions (*yajñas*) [Method-4, Ref (4)].
The *Puṣpa* (flower) symbolizes the *Prajā Paśu*, the generative principle of creation. The mantra conveys the invocation: "May the Moon (*Candrama*) bring forth from me the *Āpas* (waters), the beings (*Prajāḥ*), and the creatures (*Paśavaḥ*)." This verse elucidates the manifold modes through which the *Āpaśakti*, the primordial energy that constitutes the causal source of all creation manifests and extends itself throughout the universe [Method-5, Ref (5)].
The Vēdākshara *ta* (*takāra*) signifies *pratiṣṭhā*, establishment or grounding. The Vēda consistently employs this Vēdākshara to denote the principle of establishing all realities within oneself. Whatever endeavor a living being undertakes, it is through *ta-kāra* that consciousness attains orientation and stability. This process constitutes the essence of life itself. From *ta-kāra* arises the state of alignment (*āyatana*), which the mind then places before itself as an object of contemplation and realization [Method-6, Ref (6)].

Methods:
Method-1:
RigVēda (1-13-2)

- **देवता:** तनूनपात्
- **ऋषि:** मेधातिथिः काण्वः
- **छन्द:** गायत्री
- **स्वर:** षड्जः

मधु॑मन्तं तनूनपाद्य॒ज्ञं दे॒वेषु॑ नः कवे। अ॒द्या कृ॑णुहि वी॒तये॑॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-13-2):
The deity of this mantra is *Tanūnapāt*. Among the deities of the sacrificial fire (*Yajñāgni*), He is the one who, for my well-being, protects the body and its limbs through medicinal substances. The Yajña determines the finest and most nourishing ingredients, and the medicinal elements offered in the yajña serve to preserve and fortify the bodily organs. In this Vēdic expression, within the phrase *"ña kṛṇuhi,"* the Vēdāksharas *"ṇa"* and *"ña"* are associated with knowledge. The emergence of thought or imagination itself is *Yajña*; the power that gives rise to it is the *Kavi* (the inspired seer); and the divine movement of consciousness is embodied in *Tanūnapāt*.

Proposition:

- **Question:** What action do the nasal sounds (anunāsikas) signify in this mantra?
  Answer: In the expression *"ña kṛṇuhi"* of the Yajña, the Vēdāksharas *"ṇa"* and *"ña"* signify the act of knowledge (*jñāna-kriyā*).
- **Question:** In this mantra, what correspond to the arising of imagination, the generative power, and the divine movement of consciousness?
  Answer: The arising of imagination represents *Yajña*; the power that gives rise to imagination is the *Kavi* (the inspired seer); and the divine movement of consciousness is *Tanūnapāt* (the sacrificial fire, *Yajñāgni*).
- **Question:** Whom does the sacrificial fire (*Yajñāgni*) protect?
  Answer: It protects the bodily limbs through medicinal substances (*auṣadha*).
- **Question:** By what is the Yajña determined and established?
  Answer: By the finest and most delightful offerings (*uttamottama tīpi padārthas* – honey and clarified butter).

- **Question:** Who is the agent (*kartā*) in this mantra?
  Answer: The *Kavi* (the inspired seer).
- **Question:** What bestows happiness and well-being?
  Answer: The sacrificial fire (*Yajñāgni*).
- **Question:** To whom are the finest sweet offerings presented?
  Answer: To the deities, that is, to the *vidvans* (the enlightened or learned beings).

Conclusion of Method-1:

The Vēda employs the consonants *ka, ca, ṭa, ta,* and *pa*, along with the respective nasalized fifth Vēdāksharas of each group, to express terms related to knowledge. The ideas or imaginations that arise within us are founded upon the innate knowledge with which we are born. The emergence of imagination constitutes *Yajña* (sacrificial activity); the generative power that gives rise to it is *Prajāpati* (the Lord of creation); and the divine movement of consciousness toward realization is termed *Kalpa*. This principle has been examined and demonstrated through the support of the RigVēda (1.13.2) mantra.

Method-2:

RigVēda (1-144 -6)

- **देवता:** अग्निः
- **ऋषि:** दीर्घतमा औचथ्यः
- **छन्द:** भुरिक्पङ्क्ति
- **स्वर:** पञ्चमः

त्वं ह्यग्ने द्विव्यस्य राजसि त्वं पार्थिवस्य पशुपा इव त्मना। एनी त एते बृहती अभिश्रिया हिरण्ययी वक्वरी बर्हिराशाते ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-144-6):

O Agni! You are indeed radiant with divine brilliance, like a guardian of beings who protects through the Self. From all directions, the vast and resplendent firmaments filled with luminous gold and adorned with countless visible forms of the earthly elements extend and magnify your glory and expansion.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who is being addressed in this mantra?
  Answer: The deity addressed is *Agni*, the divine fire.
- **Question:** How is Agni described in this mantra?
  Answer: Agni is described as radiant with divine brilliance and as a guardian of beings, protecting them through the Self.
- **Question:** What is said about Agni's manifestation?
  Answer: Agni manifests as the luminous essence of divinity, comparable to the splendor of a protector who sustains life and order.
- **Question:** From where does Agni's glory expand?
  Answer: From all directions, the vast and resplendent regions of space filled with golden brilliance and innumerable visible forms of the earthly elements extend and magnify Agni's growth and radiance.
- **Question:** What do the golden and variegated cosmic regions symbolize?
  Answer: They symbolize the boundless expanse of the manifested universe that reflects and amplifies the divine energy of Agni.

Conclusion of Method-2:

This mantra portrays *Agni* as the radiant embodiment of divine consciousness that pervades and sustains the universe. He is both the protector of beings and the inner light that governs all forms of existence. The golden and variegated regions of the cosmos symbolize the infinite manifestations of his energy, each reflecting the brilliance of the divine Self. Through Agni's expanding radiance, the Vēdic vision reveals the

unity of matter and spirit, showing that all creation is illumined, nourished, and safeguarded by the eternal fire of consciousness.

The term *Paśu* signifies desire, the impulse that drives one toward attainment. When such activity is directed toward the acquisition of worldly results, it remains a mere *karma* (ordinary action). However, when the same act is imbued with divine consciousness (*dēva-bhāva*), it transforms into *Yajña* (a sacred act of offering).

- *Paśu* → represents *desire or the object of pursuit.*
- *Karma* → denotes ordinary, result-oriented action when performed for material gains.
- *Dēva-bhāva* → means "divine disposition" or a consciousness aligned with higher truth.
- When *karma* is joined with *dēva-bhāva,* it evolves into *Yajña,* symbolizing sacred, selfless action.

Method-3:

RigVēda (1-164-49)

- **देवता:** सरस्वती
- **ऋषि:** दीर्घतमा औचथ्यः
- **छन्द:** निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

यस्ते॒ स्तनः॑ शश॒यो यो म॑यो॒भूर्येन॒ विश्वा॒ पुष्य॑सि॒ वार्या॑णि। यो र॑त्न॒धा व॑सु॒विद्यः सु॒दत्रः॒ सर॑स्वति॒ तमि॒ह धात॑वे कः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-164-49):

O Sarasvatī! You sustain that pure source of blissful consciousness (that is, pure knowledge) which pervades all things. Through this pure knowledge, one attains delightful objects and acquires wealth. Whoever here employs you with the proper substances (*dhātu*), engages with you in accordance with these principles.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who is being addressed in this mantra?
  Answer: The deity addressed is *Sarasvatī*.
- **Question:** What does Sarasvatī sustain?
  Answer: She sustains the pure source of blissful consciousness, that is, pure knowledge.
- **Question:** What does pure knowledge provide?
  Answer: Pure knowledge enables one to attain delightful objects and acquire wealth.
- **Question:** How is Sarasvatī engaged or employed according to this mantra?
  Answer: Whoever here engages Sarasvatī with the proper substances (*dhātu*), applies her according to these principles.

Conclusion of Method-3:

This mantra emphasizes Sarasvatī as the embodiment of pure knowledge, the source of blissful consciousness that pervades all things. Through the proper engagement of this divine energy, one attains both delightful objects and material or intellectual wealth. The text underscores that pure knowledge is not merely theoretical but is practically realized when invoked and employed with the correct substances (*dhātu*), revealing its dual role as a source of inner joy and tangible prosperity.

Brahman is complete and perfect knowledge. That complete knowledge itself manifests as the *akṣara-śaktis*, the imperishable powers of sound. These divine energies take form as *sākāra akṣaras*, or manifest phonetic entities. The collection of such *akṣaras* constitutes the very form of *Parabrahman*. The term *Śabda-Brahman* denotes Brahman transformed into sound; hence, *Śabda-Brahman* is the embodiment of complete and absolute knowledge.

Method-4:
RigVēda (1-92-17)

- **देवता:** उषाः
- **ऋषि:** गोतमो राहूगणः
- **छन्द:** उष्णिक्
- **स्वर:** ऋषभः

यावित्था श्लोकमा दिवो ज्योतिर्जनाय चक्रथुः। आ न ऊर्जं वहतमश्विना युवम् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-92-17):
O Ashvins! You, the youthful twin deities, manifest the radiance of the Sun perfectly in all directions for the benefit of the worlds. In this manner, truth (*satya*) endows us with praise, strength, and vigor from all directions.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are the Ashvins in this mantra?
  Answer: They are the deities associated with the dawn (*Uṣā*); hence, they are linked with the rays of dawn.
- **Question:** How are the Ashvins described?
  Answer: They are described as two youthful beings.
- **Question:** Why are the Ashvins depicted as two youths?
  Answer: Because they embody the two qualities, *Iṣā* and *Ūrjas* (power and vigor).
- **Question:** What do the Ashvins do?
  Answer: They extend the radiance of the Sun in all directions for the benefit of the worlds.
- **Question:** What effect do the rays of dawn have?
  Answer: They convey truth (*satya*), bestow praise, and provide strength and vigor.

Conclusion of Method-4:
Since the Vēda has manifested into existence, every aspect within it contains both a cause and a corresponding function. The RigVēda begins with Agni, the primal energy that serves as the fundamental source of all divine powers. The YajurVēda, on the other hand, commences with Īśā and Ūrjas - the two foundational principles that constitute the causal forces behind all actions, specifically sacrificial acts (*yajñas*). This principle is demonstrated in the RigVēda (1.92.17).

Method-5:
RigVēda (10-137-6)

- **देवता:** उषाः द्वितीयस्यार्द्धर्चस्य रात्रिरपि
- **ऋषि:** कुत्स आङ्गिरसः
- **छन्द:** भुरिक्पङ्क्ति
- **स्वर:** पञ्चमः

परायतीनामन्वेति पाथ आयतीनां प्रथमा शश्वतीनाम्। व्युच्छन्ती जीवमुदीरयन्त्युषा मृतं कं चन बोधयन्ती ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-137-6):
The all-pervading waters (*jala*) undoubtedly protect against illness and disease. They remove suffering and restore health, serving as a universal remedy for all forms of bodily affliction. In this sense, the waters themselves function as your medicine or healing agent.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are the Viśvadēvas?
  Answer: The deities of this mantra are the Viśvadēvas. The Viśvadēvas are those who pervade everything. Among them, Āpaḥ (the waters) is one.
- **Question:** How is Āpaḥ the cause for all creation?
  Answer: Because Āpaḥ pervades everything, it serves as a fundamental source and sustainer of all existence.
- **Question:** What are the qualities of Āpaḥ?
  Answer: Āpaḥ possesses the qualities of preventing all illnesses, removing disease, and providing health-promoting medicinal benefits. These are the essential attributes of Āpaḥ.

Conclusion of Method-5:

The flower (*puṣpa*) symbolizes the generative principle of creation, the *Prajā Paśu*. The mantra conveys the invocation: "May the Moon (*Candrama*) bring forth from me the waters (*Āpas*), the beings (*Prajāḥ*), and the creatures (*Paśavaḥ*)." This mantra elucidates the manifold forms in which the primordial energy of water (*Āpa-śakti*), the causal source of all creation, manifests and extends throughout the universe. This principle is demonstrated with the support of the RigVēda (10.137.6) mantra.

Method-6:

RigVēda (1-113-8)

- **देवता:** उषाः द्वितीयस्यार्द्धर्चस्य रात्रिरपि
- **ऋषि:** कुत्स आङ्गिरसः
- **छन्द:** भुरिक्पङ्क्ति
- **स्वर:** पञ्चमः

प॒रा॒य॒ती॒नामन्वे॑ति॒ पाथ॑ आयती॒नां प्र॑थ॒मा शश्व॑तीनाम्। व्यु॒च्छन्ती॑ जी॒वमु॑दी॒रय॑न्त्यु॒षा मृ॒तं क॑ च॒न बो॒धय॑न्ती ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-113-8):

The early hours of the morning are cyclical, continually recurring with the passage of time. As the first darkness of the preceding period dissipates, life (*prāṇa*) is activated and directed toward action. It is as if one who has been momentarily dormant awakens, moving in accordance with the rhythm of the cosmos.

Proposition:

- **Question:** What does the usage of the Vēdākshara *ta* (*takāra*) signify in this mantra?
  Answer: It signifies the establishment (*pratiṣṭhā*) of the dawn period (*Uṣā-kāla*).
- **Question:** What dispels darkness and awakens the life-force of one nearing death?
  Answer: The dawn hours, or the early morning (*prātaḥ-kāla*).
- **Question:** What is the first action (*karman*) of the cosmos according to this mantra?
  Answer: To cyclically renew the dawn of the previous period and that of the approaching time.
- **Question:** During which period is life-force (*prāṇa*) activated and directed toward action?
  Answer: During the early morning (*prātaḥ-kāla*).
- **Question:** What does the dawn (*Uṣā*) follow and repeat?
  Answer: It follows and cyclically renews the dawn of the past period, the approaching time, and the present period.
- **Question:** What is the fundamental source power that awakens life (*prāṇa*) in this mantra?
  Answer: The cosmos (*Antarikṣa*), representing the locus (*āyatana*) where energy manifests itself.
- **Question:** What is the operative power that directly awakens life (*prāṇa*)?
  Answer: The dawn period (*Uṣā-kāla*), as the locus (*āyatana*) where energy manifests itself.
- **Question:** In the word *a + yateenām*, what is the meaning of each Vēdākshara?
  Answer:
  - *'A'* → Brahman (absolute consciousness)
  - *'Ya'* → effort or endeavor
  - *'Ta'* → establishment (*pratiṣṭhā*)

- *'I'* → the senses (*indriyas*)
- *'Na'* and *'Ma'* → knowledge (*jñāna*)

Thus, the living being brings forth the locus of consciousness within, arranging the mind in accordance with these principles.

Conclusion of Method-6:

The Vēdākshara *ta* (*ta-kāra*) signifies establishment (*pratiṣṭhā*). To establish all that exists within itself, the Vēda consistently employs *ta-kāra* in its recitations. Through the application of *takāra*, whatever effort a living being undertakes is given a locus (*āyatana*) within which it is actualized, this constitutes the essence of life. From *takāra*, the living being brings forth the locus, and the mind positions it before itself for contemplation and realization. This principle has been examined and demonstrated through the support of the RigVēda (1.113.8) mantra.

Conclusion:

In summary, the Vēda intricately links sound, knowledge, and action to the realization of divine consciousness. Through its use of specific consonants, Vēdāksharas, and mantras, it conveys the inherent relationship between ideation, desire, and the performance of Yajña. The faculties of life and cognition are employed in both worldly and sacred endeavors, with their alignment toward divine awareness transforming ordinary actions into sacred offerings. Śabda-Brahman embodies complete knowledge, manifesting as akṣaras that constitute the form of Parabrahman. The Vēdas, beginning with Agni, Iṣā, and Ūrjas, reflect the causal principles underlying all creation and sacrificial acts. Symbols such as the Puṣpa and Vēdāksharas like ta-kāra further illustrate the mechanisms through which cosmic energies are established and internalized, guiding consciousness toward stability, alignment, and realization. Collectively, these insights affirm the Vēda's comprehensive methodology for understanding the interplay of sound, knowledge, and spiritual action.

References:

1. RigVēda (1-13-2)
2. RigVēda (1-144-6)
3. RigVēda (1-164- 49)
4. RigVēda (1-92-17)
5. RigVēda (10-137-6)
6. RigVēda (1-113-8)